

SCAFFOLDS A STUDENT CAN GROW WITH

Self-Advocacy Worksheets for Deaf & Hard of Hearing Students

Four short, reusable worksheets a Teacher of the Deaf, itinerant ToD, or case manager works through with a student — upper-elementary through high school. Wording is written to flex across that range; adapt it further to your student's grade and reading level as needed.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This is a teaching support, not a medical or device recommendation.
However a student communicates — ASL, spoken language, a hearing device, or a combination — these pages adapt to that student, not the other way around.

Practice: “I need...” sentence starters

Fill in each blank with what actually helps you. There's no wrong answer here — this is about your own words, not what's “supposed to” happen.

STUDENT WRITE-IN WORKSHEET

In a noisy room, I need _____

When directions are only given out loud, I need _____

When I can't see your face or lips, I need _____

When my hearing device or communication support isn't working, I need _____

During a video with no captions, I need _____

When I miss part of what a classmate said, I need _____

In a fire drill or loud alarm, I need _____

When a substitute doesn't know my accommodations, I need _____

This week: check what's true for you

This isn't your IEP — it's a quick way to notice what's working right now and what's worth bringing up at your next check-in. Check off anything that's true for you this week.

STUDENT SELF-CHECK (CHECKBOXES)

- ☐ I sat where I could see the teacher's face and the board.
- ☐ Captions were on for any video we watched in class.
- ☐ When I didn't catch something, someone repeated or rephrased it — not just said it louder.
- ☐ I could see who was talking during group work or discussion.
- ☐ I knew a backup way to get instructions if I missed them the first time.
- ☐ I felt okay asking for something I needed this week.

Something to bring up at my next check-in:

Build your script: meeting a new teacher

New term, new teacher? Fill in the blanks to build a short script you can say — or hand over — in the first week of class.

STUDENT WRITE-IN WORKSHEET

Hi, I'm _____. Something you should know about how I communicate is _____ (in your own words — ASL, spoken language, a device, or however fits).

Something that helps me in class is _____

If you need to get my attention, the best way is _____

If I don't understand something, here's how I'll let you know _____

Practice saying it out loud once before you need it for real — with your ToD, a parent, or on your own.

Practice scenarios: real situations, safe practice

Read each scenario together. Practice saying what you'd do — out loud with a ToD or family member, or by writing it in the space below.

STUDENT WRITE-IN WORKSHEET

Scenario 1 · Group work

Your table is working fast and a few people are talking over each other. What do you say?

Scenario 2 · Fire drill or loud alarm

The alarm goes off and it's loud, sudden, and confusing. What do you need in that moment?

Scenario 3 · A video with no captions

Your class starts a video and there are no captions turned on. What do you do?

Scenario 4 · A substitute who doesn't know

A substitute is running class today and doesn't know your accommodations. What's the first thing you'd tell them?
